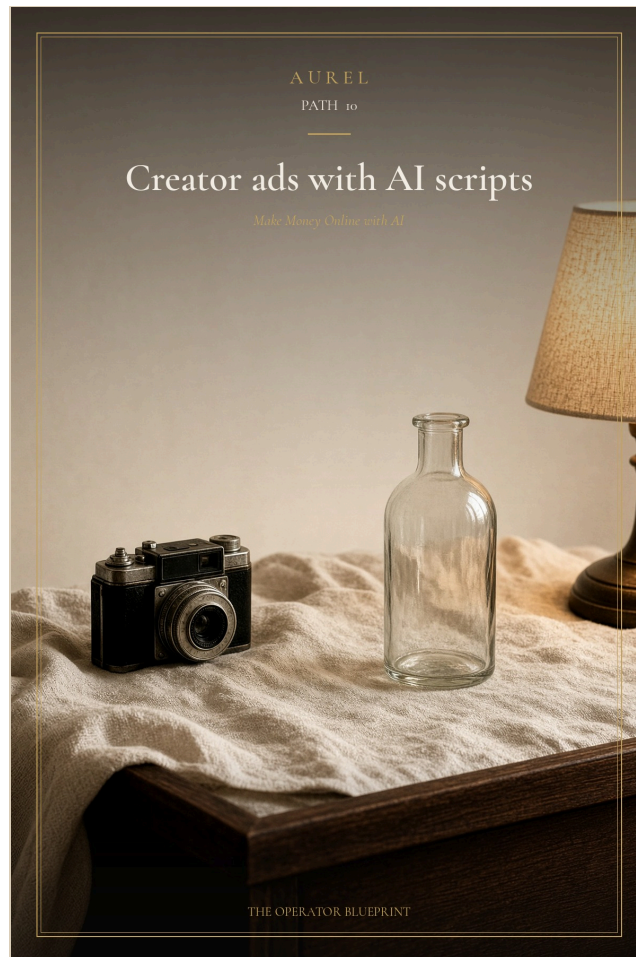




PATH 10

Creator ads with AI scripts

Brands need simple product videos. You do not need to be famous. You need to be clear.

39 minute read · 8,655 words

Who this is for

You are comfortable on camera. You can hold a product and talk.

Time to first

7–21 days

Tools

First sale

One paid brief for two videos.

Cash window

\$150–\$800 for a first two-video pack

Leave this alone

Phone, CapCut, a rate card, AI for script outlines only. Working for exposure. Promising virality.

What you are selling

Definition

UGC-style ads are not influencer fame. They are short product videos a brand can run as ads or organic posts. Demo, list, stitch, talking-head. Fifteen to thirty seconds. Vertical. You on camera, product in hand, a sentence a person would actually say in a store aisle.

The buyer is a small brand that cannot hire a studio and does not want another polished TV spot. They want a video that looks like a customer. You are that customer, on purpose, with a script you can say without blinking at a teleprompter.

AI drafts the script outline. You throw away anything you would not say out loud to a friend while chopping onions. If the model writes a line about a revolutionary garlic press transforming your weeknight ritual, that line dies. I used to smash garlic with a knife and a prayer. This thing takes four seconds. That stays.

You do not need to be famous. You need to be clear. A sample ad for a product already on your shelf is your portfolio. Two samples beat a nine-page media kit with follower screenshots. Brands who pay \$400 for two videos are not buying your audience. They are buying files they can load into Ads Manager this week.

What this is not

This is not a promise that the ad will go viral. You cannot promise that. Anyone who asks you to guarantee ROAS on day one is asking you to lie or to become their media buyer. You are the creator of the asset. Media buying is a second package, later, if you even want it.

This is not working for exposure, free product, or we will tag you. Free product is not a brief. A paid pack is a brief. If you want the product, buy it and film a sample. Then send the invoice path, not the barter path.

This is not a faceless slideshow with stock clips and an AI voice. Brands hiring this path want a person holding the thing. Faceless ads exist. They are a different product. Do not mix them on the same rate card. This is also not a retainer on day one. Two videos. One pack. A date.

Why this works now

Small brands still need ads that look like a person. Studio spots feel like 2014. Influencer retainers feel like a second rent. A \$400 two-video pack sits in the gap: cheap enough to expense, specific enough to run this week. Warm email to a brand you already buy from still cuts through marketplace \$50 videos. You are not bidding. You are a customer with a camera and a deadline.

AI collapsed the outline cost. Hook, problem, demo, proof, ask used to take an hour of staring. Now it takes ten minutes plus a rewrite in your mouth. The rewrite is the work. If you ship the model's sentences, you will sound like every other creator they already tried. Phones are good enough. 1080p vertical, a window, captions. The quality bar moved from cinematic to clear.

Three anti-patterns

Anti-pattern one: the fame pitch. You lead with follower counts, a media kit, and a promise that this will blow up. The brand wanted files. You sold a lottery ticket. They either decline or they hire you and then blame you when the ad does not print money. Sell the files. Leave the lottery.

Anti-pattern two: the marketplace race. You wait for a platform to send brands. You bid \$75 against people who will do it for \$40. You learn to work cheap and stay quiet. Five emails to brands you already use is the channel until you have cases.

Anti-pattern three: the hostage script. You read the AI outline word for word, eyes flicking off camera, mouth in a shape no human uses in a kitchen. Rewrite until you can say it while walking to the sink. If you stumble, the line is too long. Cut it.

The deal you keep

You keep two sample ads in one niche, a \$400 pack on a page, a deposit before you shoot, one revision in writing, and no virality promise anywhere. You keep claims you can stand behind. You keep files named like an adult, delivered in a folder they own.

You do not keep a fantasy of becoming the face of a national brand in month one. You do not keep unpaid collabs. You do not keep a twelve-item menu before two samples exist. Kitchen-tool product videos. Two files. Seven days. That is the deal. It is smaller than the influencer version. It pays.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

Fits if

This path fits if you are comfortable on camera. Not love being an influencer. Comfortable. You can hold a product, talk for twenty seconds, and not apologize to the lens. A kitchen, a window, a phone is enough. You do not need a ring light army.

It also fits if you already buy in a niche: kitchen tools, skincare you actually use, hardware in the garage, a software login you open every morning. The niche is the drawer you already have. Samples from that drawer are honest. Samples from a niche you are faking will sound like a press release. You can say a price out loud. You can send five emails this week. You will take a deposit before you shoot.

Skip if

Skip it if you hate being on camera and were hoping the model would generate a face. Faceless slideshow ads exist. They are a different product. This path is you, a product, a sentence.

Skip it if you want to wait for a marketplace to send you brands. Those platforms take a cut and train you to bid against people who work for \$50. You will email five brands you already use.

Skip it if you will promise virality to close the deal. Sell the files, the deadline, and one revision. Not a lottery ticket.

Skip it if you need rent this Friday. Time to first is 7–21 days. Pair this with a service week if cash is tight. Do not take product-only. Skip it if you will not pick a niche, or if you freeze at sending five notes. The emails are the business.

The honest middle

Shy is allowed. Mute is not. You can talk to the product instead of the lens on sample one. You still need to be willing to be seen. If you have a page and no emails, you do not have a business yet. You need two honest clips and five brands who already sold you something.

Skills and time

Skills: hold a product, speak twenty seconds, trim a clip, burn captions, write a six-line email, take a deposit. Time: two evenings plus five emails. First paid brief can land inside 7–21 days. The seven-day clock starts when the thing arrives. Budget: \$0 if you already have a phone and two products. A ring light is later, after a brand has paid.

Two-minute self-test

Answer out loud. Stall on two and skip this path this month.

Can you hold a product and talk for twenty seconds without apologizing?

What drawer do you already buy from, named as a niche, not a vibe?

Will you film two sample ads this week for products you own?

Can you say two videos, one revision, seven days, \$400 without flinching?

Will you send five emails to brands you already use, this week, not after a media kit?

Will you refuse exposure, free product, and a virality clause?

Six yeses. Start. Four or fewer: pick a closer niche, get on camera tonight, or take a different path.

The offer, named in one sentence

Fill this before you film

Write this on the rate card before you film: Two product videos, one revision, seven days, \$400. Vertical files you can run. Samples on this page.

That is the whole offer. Not a menu of 12 packages. Not a 20-video retainer. Two videos. One pack. A date.

If you cannot name the niche in the sentence — two kitchen-tool product videos — you do not have an offer yet. I make UGC is a category. Categories do not get replies.

Offer sentences that already work

Two kitchen-tool product videos, 15–30 seconds, vertical, one revision, seven days from product-in-hand. \$400. Samples on this page.

Two skincare-on-a-real-face videos for the product I already use. Captions on. One revision. Seven days. \$400.

Two hardware-in-the-garage demos, product in the first two seconds, files you can run this week. \$400.

Two talking-head plus demo clips for a software login I actually open. No fake dashboard. \$400.

Two videos for your new SKU in the same niche as my samples. Deposit holds the week. \$400.

Write yours with a niche a brand will recognize. Do not write short-form content for growing brands. That is a cloud. A cloud does not get a wire.

What they get

Deliverable: two 15–30 second vertical videos (9:16), captions burned in, raw clips optional if you want to upsell later.

Process: they send the product facts and claims they can actually make. You script, shoot, edit. They get one round of notes. You deliver files, not a login to your brain.

Timeline: seven days from product-in-hand (or from the day they ship it to you) to files in a folder.

Price: \$400 for the first two-video pack in kitchen tools. The cash window for a first pack anywhere in this path is \$150–\$800. Start where you can say the number without flinching, then raise.

One revision window, 48 hours, written notes. After that, new work is a new invoice.

Files named like an adult. Folder they own. No watermark. No your-logo end card unless they paid for a brand frame.

What they do not get

A virality guarantee. A ROAS number. Media buying. A 40-minute discovery call that becomes free consulting. Unlimited rounds. A 12-hook testing matrix inside \$400. Your audience. A usage-rights fight. You on a monthly retainer before you have delivered once.

They also do not get medical claims, fake urgency you know is false, or a line about doctors hating this. If they need that, they need a different vendor.

Packaging

One page. Two embedded samples. The rate card line. Three add-ons: 72-hour rush +\$150, extra revision +\$75, extra video in the same shoot +\$150. Deposit link. Brief form. Email you actually check.

Do not build a Figma palace. Do not list 12 packages. Two videos, one price, one niche. Then a rate card add-on. Then a retainer. In that order.

What done looks like

Definition

Done is a paid brief, not a sample sitting in your camera roll. The first sale is one brand saying yes and paying a deposit for two videos.

Done for a pack is two finished vertical files a muted stranger can follow, a 3-second hook that names the job, claims you can stand behind, one revision round in writing, files named like an adult, deposit taken before you shoot, balance on delivery. You are not a bank.

Done for the business, week one, is smaller: two sample ads live on a page with the \$400 pack spelled out, five emails sent. If those five are not sent, you do not have a business. You have homework.

The fairness test

Hand the two files to someone who does not know the brand. Phone, muted, vertical. Can they name the product and the job in three seconds? If they cannot, the hook failed. Can they follow the captions without squinting? If they cannot, you stacked three lines. Would you say the script in a store aisle? If not, you shipped a press release.

Fairness also means the brand can load the files this week. No watermark. No missing captions. No 400 MB monsters. Folder. Names. Done. Fairness means you did not promise views. The page does not say this will go viral. You sold files. That is what arrived.

Technical done (week 1)

Niche picked from a drawer you already have

Two sample ads shot and edited, 15–30 seconds, captions on

Rate card: two videos, one revision, seven days, \$400

Rush, extra revision, extra video written as add-ons

One page with samples, price, deposit link

Brief form live: facts, claims you will not make, examples they like

Five emails sent to brands you already buy

No virality promise anywhere on the page

Technical done (a paid pack)

Deposit in before you shoot

Product in hand, or a written date they will ship

Script said out loud. AI lines you would not say are gone

Two vertical mp4s, 15–30 seconds, product in the first two seconds

Captions a muted viewer can follow, one short line at a time

No medical claims, no fake urgency, no statistic you invented

Files named Brand-Product-A-hook1.mp4 and Brand-Product-B-demo.mp4

Folder they own, no watermark

One revision window, 48 hours, written notes

Balance paid

Ask for the next SKU and one referral, sent while they are happy

Not done yet

Samples in camera roll, no page

Page live, zero emails

Yes from a brand, no deposit, you already shot

Make it pop accepted as a revision note

Third round inside the same \$400

Media buying promised so they would say yes

Product-only accepted as payment

A claim on camera the brand cannot defend

If three of those are true, you are busy, not running this path. Fix the list this week.

Pricing the two-video pack

Ranges

Cash window: \$150–\$800 for a first two-video pack. Alex's kitchen-tool pack sits at \$400. That number is high enough to filter hobby brands who want free content, and low enough that a six-person company can expense it without a board meeting.

\$150–\$250 if you have zero samples and need a first paid case. Say it is a founder rate for the first two brands, then it becomes \$400. Write the date you will stop discounting. Do not live there.

\$400 is the default once two samples exist. Two videos, one revision, seven days. Rush in 72 hours: add \$150. Extra revision: \$75. Extra video in the same shoot: \$150. Raw clips folder: \$50. Write those add-ons on the rate card so they do not become a conversation.

\$600–\$800 when you have three paid brands in the same niche and a folder of ads that ran. Do not jump there on day one. You have no proof yet. A monthly four-video retainer, first Friday:

\$700–\$1,200 after you have delivered three packs without drama. Not before.

Worked dollars

Alex lists \$400. Five emails. One yes on day 9. 50% deposit = \$200 before the product ships. Product arrives day 12. Shoot Saturday. Deliver Monday. One revision: last six seconds, messy sink. Balance \$200. Pack cash: \$400. Time from first email to files: 16 days. Inside the 7–21 day window.

Next six weeks: the juicer owner forwards the page. Two more kitchen brands, same pack, same \$400. One takes the extra-video add-on at \$150. Three-pack cash: \$1,350. Not rent in a coastal city. Proof. The niche is now a sentence you can say at a market stall.

If Alex had taken product-only on pack one, cash is \$0 and a juicer they did not need. If Alex had said \$150 forever, three packs = \$450 and a trained cheap buyer. The \$400 is the point.

Rush example: brand needs files Friday, it is Tuesday, product is in hand. $\$400 + \$150 = \$550$. The extra is the calendar, not more work on the lens.

Ten-video week: that is a different package. 10 videos, two revision rounds, 14 days, \$1,600, 50% deposit. Do not say yes at \$400.

What you never do

You never work for exposure. You never take we will send you the product and a coupon code as payment. You never promise a CPM, a ROAS, or a view count. You sell files. If they want you to run the ads too, that is a second package with a second price, and you should not sell it until you have delivered the files once.

You never hide the number behind DM me for rates. The page says \$400. Deposit 50% to hold the week. Balance on delivery. Pick one rule for when balance is due. Put it on the page.

Refunds in one sentence

If I miss the deadline without a product delay on your side, you get the deposit back or I finish at no extra fee. You pick. I do not refund because the ad did not go viral. I sold files.

When to raise

After three paid packs in the same niche, \$500. After a folder of ads that actually ran, \$600–\$800. After a repeat brand asks for a monthly four-pack, quote the retainer. Do not raise because one video got comments. Comments are not a case.

The first 72 hours

Film two sample ads. Edit. Put them on a simple page with a package: two videos, one revision, a deadline, a price. Send the page to five small brands you already use. Do not wait to be discovered on a marketplace.

Hours 1–8: niche, hooks, voice memos

Pick the niche from your own shelf. Kitchen tools if that is your drawer. Take two products you already own. Write three hook options each. Speak them into a voice memo. Keep the ones you would say in a store. Throw out the ones that sound like a banner ad. Ask the model for six hook outlines, then cut anything you would not say while chopping onions. The model is a starter. Your mouth is the filter.

Hours 9–24: shoot and a first export

Shoot by a window. Phone vertical. Product in frame in the first two seconds. One take that is good enough. Then a second angle: demo the tool actually working. Audio: dishwasher off, hood fan off. Edit in CapCut: captions, a light crop, 20 seconds, no trending audio you do not have the rights to. Export 9:16. Watch it muted. If you cannot follow it, fix the captions before you build a page.

Hours 25–48: the page and the rate card

A one-page site or a Notion page: two embedded samples, the rate card line, a deposit link, an email. Headline names the niche. Kitchen-tool product videos. You get files, not a follower pitch. Write the three add-ons. Write the brief questions. Write the claims-you-will-not-make box. Test the deposit link from a second device. Two videos and a number. No 900-word about page.

Hours 49–72: five emails, not a media kit

Send five notes to brands you already buy from. I made two kitchen-tool videos as samples. I can do two for [product] in seven days for \$400, one revision. Page: [link]. That is the 72 hours. No media kit. No waiting.

Pick brands you can name without a spreadsheet of 200. The citrus juicer with 12,000 followers. The mill seller in the cupboard. Not Amazon house brands. Not a giant with a 14-step vendor portal. Follow-up is day 4, not hour 70. Do not build a marketplace profile instead of sending the five.

The path, step by step

Step 1. Rate card before more gear

Starter pack: two videos, one revision, seven days, \$400. Rush fee. Extra revision. Extra video. Put it on one page. If you cannot say the number out loud, the number is wrong or you are not ready to send email.

Step 2. Niche you already buy in

Kitchen tools, software, skincare, hardware. One. Stay there until you have repeat clients. A sample from your own shelf is honest. A sample from a niche you searched this morning will sound like it. Pick the drawer.

Step 3. Two sample ads, not a PDF about your media kit

Film a demo and a talking-head for products you own. Brands hire from video. They do not hire from a bio. Fifteen to thirty seconds. Captions on. Product in the first two seconds. One sample looks like a hobby.

Step 4. Page with the pack spelled out

Two embeds. The sentence. Deposit link. Brief form. That is the page. Test it on a phone. If the deposit link 404s, you are not ready to email.

Step 5. Five emails to brands you already use

Six lines. The page. A still from one sample. No attachment pack. No we should hop on a call. Send them in one sitting. If you cannot name five brands you already buy, your niche is a mood, not a drawer.

Step 6. Brief intake, a form, not a 40-minute discovery call

Product facts. Three claims they can legally make. Claims you will not make. Two example ads they like (not make it viral). Ship-to address. Deadline. Send the form first. Fifteen minutes after the deposit is allowed. Before money is not.

Step 7. Deposit before you shoot

50% holds the week. Do not start a script for a maybe. Do not buy \$200 of inventory on a maybe. If they stall on the deposit, they were not a brief.

Step 8. Script in your mouth

AI outline: hook, problem, demo, proof, ask. Then rewrite until you can say it while walking across the kitchen. Record a voice memo. If you stumble, the line is too long. Cut fake urgency and any claim the intake forbade.

Step 9. Shoot

Window light. Phone at eye height. Product in the first two seconds. Do the job on camera — press the garlic, peel the orange, click the software. Two or three takes per hook is enough. Twenty takes is how you miss the deadline.

Step 10. Edit

CapCut is enough. Captions. Cut the breath you took before the sentence. End on the product name and the one action. Stay off music you cannot license. Silence plus the room plus your voice is legal and human.

Step 11. Deliver vertical files they can run

9:16, under 100 MB if you can help it, no watermark, no your-logo end card unless they paid for a brand frame. Named. Folder they own. Send the delivery note with the 48-hour revision window in the same message.

Step 12. One revision window

Written notes, 48 hours, one round. Make it pop is not a note. Swap the first line for the one about the dishwasher is a note. After the window, new invoice. If they send a novel, pick two changes and name the rest as a \$75 extra round.

Step 13. Ask for the next SKU and one referral

While they are happy. If the juicer has a sibling product, I can shoot it in the same setup for \$150 extra next week. Then: Who else in kitchen tools should see the samples? Do this the day they say the files work.

Step 14. Stay in one niche

The second brand is easier when you can say I already shot a press, a peeler, and a juicer. Crossing into dental ads because someone asked is how you restart from zero. The niche is the asset.

Step 15. Raise or productize

After three paid packs, \$500. After a folder of work, a monthly four videos, first Friday retainer. Not before you have delivered once without drama. Do not raise because you bought a light.

Step 16. Leave the marketplace alone until the five emails have had a chance

A profile on a UGC app is allowed later, when you have a pack and a rate and you will not bid \$50. It is a trap as your only channel. The five emails are the work.

Worked example: Alex and the \$400 kitchen-tool pack

Alex cooks most nights in a small apartment kitchen. No studio. A window over the sink. A drawer of tools bought over a few years. That drawer is the niche. Alex did not pick kitchen tools because of a trend report. Alex picked them because the garlic press was already there.

The two samples

Sample 1, garlic press: 18 seconds. Hook: I used to mince garlic with a knife and it made the whole board smell for days. Demo: clove in, squeeze, peel the leftover skin, rinse. Last line: Four seconds, and the board stays clean. No music fight. Captions on.

Sample 2, silicone spatula: 22 seconds. Hook: If your spatula melts on the pan, that is not a personality, that is a bad tool. Demo: scramble, scrape, hold it against the edge. Last line: This one does not smell like burnt rubber. I checked.

Both shot in one evening. Edited the next morning in CapCut. On a one-page site with this line: Two product videos, one revision, seven days. \$400. Samples on this page. Deposit link under the sentence.

Calendar with dollars

Day 1, evening: niche picked, three hooks per product spoken into a memo, two kept. Day 2, after work: window shoot, two products, six takes total. Day 3, morning: CapCut, captions, two exports. Night: page live, \$400 pack, deposit link tested. Days 4–7: five emails, one per night so they actually went out. No marketplace profile.

The five emails: not Amazon house brands, not All-Clad. A citrus juicer company with 12,000 Instagram followers. A board-scraper shop. A mill seller. Two spatula companies. Each note was six lines, the page link, and a still from the garlic-press ad. No media kit.

Day 8: silence. Alex did not rebuild the page. Day 9: the juicer brand replied. They had a new hand juicer. They wanted two ads: one demo, one why I switched from a cheap press. They asked if Alex could also run the ads and get us views. Alex said no to the media buying, yes to the \$400 pack, 50% deposit. \$200 in on day 9. Product arrived on day 12. Seven-day clock starts at in-hand: files due day 19.

Day 13: brief form back. Three true facts. One claim they must not make: no clinically proven juice yield. Two example ads they liked, both demo-heavy. Day 14: script outline from the model. Alex cut three fake-urgency lines and the yield claim. Voice memo in the kitchen. Two lines still too long. Cut.

Day 16, Saturday: shoot. Same window, same phone, juicer in the first two seconds. Day 18, Monday: deliver two vertical files, named, folder they own. One revision requested: they wanted the sink less messy in the background. Alex reshot the last six seconds that night. Day 19: revised file in the folder. Balance \$200. Pack total \$400.

Elapsed from first email to files: 16 days. Time to first paid brief: inside the 7–21 day window. Cash: \$400, zero ad spend, zero marketplace cut.

What happened next

Alex did not become famous. Two more kitchen brands hired in the next six weeks because the juicer owner forwarded the page. Same pack. Same \$400. Same niche. One took the extra-video add-on at \$150. Three-pack cash: \$1,350. Alex almost titled the page UGC creator for hire, almost said yes to running the ads, almost took the juicer as payment. The rate card saved the number. The drawer saved the niche.

Ninety days

Seven paid packs in kitchen tools. Two repeats from the juicer brand. Still no marketplace profile. Still no virality line on the page. The business is files, a niche, and emails. That is enough.

Copy you can paste

Swap the niche. Keep the kitchen voice. Do not add a virality line.

1. Rate card line

Two product videos, one revision, seven days. \$400. Samples on this page.

2. Add-ons, same card

72-hour rush: +\$150

Extra revision round: +\$75

Extra video in the same shoot: +\$150

Raw clips folder: +\$50

3. Email to a brand you already buy from

Hi [name] — I already use [product]. I make short product videos brands can run as ads. Two samples here: [link]. I can do two videos for [their product] in seven days, one revision, \$400. 50% to hold the week. If the timing is wrong, ignore this.

4. Follow-up, four days later, one line

Looping this to the top in case it got buried. Samples still here: [link]. Two videos, seven days, \$400. No need to reply if it is a next-quarter thing.

5. Page headline and sub

Kitchen-tool product videos. You get files, not a follower pitch.

Two 15–30 second vertical videos. One revision. Seven days from product-in-hand. \$400. I do not promise views. I deliver files you can run this week.

6. Brief questions (send as a form)

Product name and the URL

Three facts that are true

Any claim I must not make

Two ads you like (links)

Where to ship the product, or a date I can film what I have

Deadline, if it is not seven days from in-hand

7. Delivery note

Files are in this folder. Two vertical mp4s, captions on. One revision window, 48 hours, written notes. After that I am glad to do another round as a \$75 add-on. I do not run the ads unless we quote that separately.

8. Decline media buying

I can make the two videos. I cannot run your ads or promise a ROAS. If you want files this week, the \$400 pack is the thing. If you need a media buyer, that is a different vendor. Happy to stay in my lane.

9. Decline product-only

I buy my own samples. A paid brief is a paid brief. If the product needs to ship for the shoot, I take 50% to hold the week, then you ship. I do not swap the invoice for a box.

10. Ask for the next SKU

If [product] has a sibling SKU, I can shoot it in the same setup for \$150 extra as a third video, or as a new two-pack at \$400 next week. Same captions, same folder habit. Want me to hold a day?

11. Referral ask

Glad the files worked. Who else in [niche] should see the samples? A name and an email is enough. I will not say you sent me unless you want that.

12. Revision window closed

The 48 hours are up and the pack is closed. I can do another round as a \$75 extra revision. Send written notes and I will quote a turnaround. No rush fee unless you need it inside 72 hours.

Week-by-week

Assume evenings plus one weekend shoot. You can have a job. This is not a studio calendar.

Week 1: two samples and five emails

Day 1: pick the niche and the two products on your shelf. Speak hooks. Throw out banner-ad lines.

Day 2: shoot by the window. Product in the first two seconds. Dishwasher off.

Day 3: edit, captions, page with the \$400 pack, deposit link tested.

Days 4–7: five emails to brands you already buy. Do not build a marketplace profile instead of sending the five. Do not film a third sample in a second niche. Done bar for the week: two live samples, a number on a page, five sends.

Week 2: follow-up and a sixth brand if needed

One follow-up, four days later, one line: Looping this to the top in case it got buried. Samples still here: [link]. If someone says maybe next quarter, ask if they have a sibling SKU now.

If you have zero replies, send five more in the same niche. Change the subject line to the product you already use. Check that the page loads on a phone. Do not switch to skincare on day eight. The niche is the asset. The emails are the work.

If a yes arrives: deposit, form, wait for the box. Do not script a full ad for a brand that has not paid.

Week 3: deliver the first paid brief

Deposit, intake, script in your mouth, shoot, edit, files. One revision. Ask for the next SKU and one name. Do not start a skincare sample while you wait. Do not say yes to running the ads to keep them happy.

Protect the seven days from in-hand. If the box is late, the clock has not started. Tell them that in one sentence. Write down what broke: audio, sink, a claim you cut. That list is week 4's checklist.

Week 4: stay in the niche

Second pack at the same \$400, or founder-rate closed. Four videos in your folder is a portfolio. Forty half-finished ideas is not.

If you have no paid brief yet: ten total emails in the same niche, page still one offer, samples still the same two. Improve a hook if it sounded like a press release. Do not add a \$97 coaching call to the page.

If you have two yeses: deliver both without stacking them on the same Saturday unless they are the same setup. Raise nothing yet. The retainer talk waits until three clean deliveries.

The quality bar

Clear beats cinematic. A stable phone, a window, and a sentence you would say in a store will outperform a shaky dolly shot with a script you cannot pronounce.

Picture and sound

Product in the first two seconds. If they have to wait for the brand, they swipe.

Face or hands, plus the tool doing the job. Talking-head with the product off-screen is a podcast.

Audio you can hear on a phone speaker. A \$20 lav or a quiet room. The dishwasher is off.

Captions. Most people watch muted. If the caption is the whole script in three giant lines, it is unreadable. One short line at a time.

Vertical 9:16. No letterboxing you forgot to crop. No watermark. No trending audio you do not own.

Claims

You do not make medical claims. You do not make this will change your life in 7 days claims you know are false. You do not invent a statistic. If the brand sends a claim you would not repeat to a friend, you send it back. The ad is their legal problem and your name on camera. Both matter. Fake countdown clocks are the same family. Cut them.

Human

If you would not say it in a store aisle, it does not go in the video. AI outlines. You speak. A little mess in a real kitchen is trust. A fake marble island with a product still in the shipping tape is not.

Voice-memo test: if you cannot walk and talk it, it is not ready.

Five tests this week

Mute test: watch both samples with sound off. Can you follow the job?

Three-second test: can a stranger name the product by second three?

Store-aisle test: would you say this to a person next to you at the shelf?

Claims test: is every fact on the intake, not in the model's imagination?

Phone-speaker test: play it in a kitchen, not on studio headphones. If you cannot hear you, they cannot hear you.

If two fail, do not email five brands yet. Fix the files. The page cannot save a hostage script.

What to measure

You are selling packs, not views. Measure the business you control.

Week 1

Emails sent. Five is the floor. Zero emails means zero briefs, no matter how good the garlic press ad is.

Page loads on a phone. Deposit link works.

Samples exist, 15–30 seconds, captions on.

A paid-brief cycle

Replies and yeses. A 20–40% reply rate on warm brands you already buy from is normal. Cold marketplace bids will be worse. Stay warm until you have cases.

Days from yes to deposit. If this is more than three, you are hopping on calls instead of sending a button.

Days from product-in-hand to files. Target seven. If it is 18, your revision process or your shoot block is sloppy.

Revision count. One is the package. Two means your brief missed the claims list. Three means you are training them to use you as an art department.

Pack cash collected. Deposit plus balance. Not promised. Collected.

Day 90

Repeat rate. The goal is a second SKU from the same brand, not a new niche. One repeat in the first five clients is a real business.

Referral count. One forward from a happy brand beats twenty marketplace bids.

Niche concentration. If more than one of five packs left the drawer, you are restarting.

Add-on attach. If nobody takes rush or extra video, that is fine. If everyone demands extra rounds inside \$400, your window copy is weak.

Ignore

Follower count. Views on the sample. Likes on a public post of the garlic press. Time spent shopping for lights. A brand's ROAS. You did not buy the traffic. You made the file. If they insist on performance as your metric, ask for a screenshot later as a favor, not a warranty.

Spreadsheet

date | brand | niche | pack \$ | deposit in | in-hand date | files sent | revisions | balance in | next SKU asked | referral asked

Objections you will hear

Can you do it for product only?

No. Working for exposure is the thing to leave alone. You can buy the product and film a sample. Their product in the mail is not a salary. If they push, send the rate card line again and stop explaining.

We need this to go viral.

You cannot promise that. You can promise two clear videos in seven days. If they need a virality clause, they need a different vendor, or they need to run paid ads. Do not meet in the middle with I will try to make it trendy.

We already have a UGC platform.

Good. Those platforms are full of \$50 videos. Your page is two samples in their exact niche and a human email. Some brands still want that. If they do not, next email.

Can we hop on a call?

Maybe a 15-minute walkthrough after the deposit. A 40-minute let us explore call before money is the job. Send the brief form first.

Our last creator made medical claims and we got flagged.

Put the claims-you-will-not-make box on the intake. Write it: I will not say anything you cannot stand behind. Then keep that promise on camera even if a marketing intern wants punchier.

\$400 seems high for two TikToks.

They are not TikToks. They are product videos a brand can run. Two samples are on the page. If \$400 is wrong for them, \$150 for exposure is wrong for you.

Can you also run the ads / set up the pixel / write the landing page?

No inside this pack. That is a second quote, and you should not sell it until the files have shipped once.

We need ten videos by Friday.

That is a different package. Quote it: 10 videos, two revision rounds, 14 days, \$1,600, 50% deposit. Do not say yes at \$400. Do not say yes at all if you cannot shoot that volume without wrecking another deadline. A no with a real quote is cleaner than a late yes.

Can you make it more on-brand / use our jingle / wear our hat?

If they send a hat, maybe. If they send a jingle they do not own, no. If more on-brand means a studio set you do not have, the samples already showed the kitchen. You sell the kitchen.

We will pay after we see how it performs.

No. Deposit to hold the week. Balance on delivery. Performance is their media plan. You sold files.

What this path feeds next

A finished pack is a case. Cases feed a \$19 playbook and a skill pack of the outlines you actually used. Do not sell those until you have delivered paid work. Selling scripts you have never shot is a different kind of fiction.

The same niche becomes a retainer: four videos a month, first Friday, one price. Local brands in your town who sell kitchen tools will hire you faster than a national name. Walk in with the two samples on your phone.

Repeat SKUs from one brand are the cleanest growth. Same kitchen, same light, new tool. \$150 extra in the same shoot, or a new \$400 pack. That is how \$1,200 months happen without a new niche.

What this does not feed: a personal brand built on promising you can make anything viral. Keep the page boring and specific. Kitchen-tool product videos. Files in seven days.

What this feeds badly: jumping into faceless AI ads, then into media buying, then into a UGC course, before three packs exist. One niche. Files. Then the \$19 outline pack if people ask how you script. Then a retainer. In that order.

Mistakes that kill this path

1. Medical claims and fake urgency

Clinically proven on a garlic press. Doctors hate this. A countdown you know is false. You will get a brand flagged and you will not get the second SKU. Recovery: cut the line before export. If it already shipped, send a clean cut the same day. Do not argue that it was punchy.

2. Unlimited rounds

One revision is a package. Open-ended until we love it is a second job you forgot to price. Recovery: one sentence, the window is closed, extra round is \$75. Do not gift a third round because you feel awkward. Awkward is cheaper than a trained bad client.

3. Waiting for a platform to send you brands

Marketplaces train you to race to \$75. Five emails to brands you already use is the channel. Recovery: close the app. Send five notes this week. You can return to the marketplace after three paid packs, at your rate, not theirs.

4. Working for exposure

Free product is not a brief. A tag is not a deposit. Recovery: if you already shot for a box, write it off as a sample you chose to make and never do it again. Change the page so the next brand cannot go there.

5. Reading the AI script like a hostage

If you cannot say it in the kitchen, it does not go in the ad. Recovery: voice memo walk. Cut every stumble. Reshoot twenty seconds, not the identity. The model can draft. It cannot stand in your kitchen.

6. Promising virality

You do not control distribution. Sell the files. Recovery: if you already promised it in an email, reply once: I cannot guarantee views. I can deliver the two files on the date. If they need a clause, refund the deposit and leave. Staying is how you get blamed for Ads Manager.

7. A 12-item menu before two samples exist

Two videos, one price, one niche. Then a rate card add-on. Then a retainer. In that order.

Recovery: delete the menu. Leave the \$400 pack. You can add rush and extra video as three lines, not twelve packages.

8. Shooting before the deposit

You are not a bank. Recovery: pause. Send the deposit link. If they ghost, you lost time, not a week of editing. If the product is already in your house, it sits until money sits.

9. Switching niches on day eight

Silence is normal. Skincare will not save a kitchen page that never got ten emails. Recovery: five more emails, same drawer. Change the subject line to the product you use. Do not film a serum “to have options.”

10. Accepting make it pop as a note

That note will eat the revision window and still not be done. Recovery: ask for one concrete swap — first line, background, a claim to cut. If they cannot name one, you are done. Ship the files you have.

11. Music you do not own

Trending audio can get an ad pulled. Recovery: export a silent-plus-voice cut the same day. Tell the brand why. Do not argue that everyone uses it. Everyone gets ads taken down too.

12. Saying yes to ten videos at two-video prices

Recovery: send the 10-video quote. If they already think you said yes, unsaid it in writing the same day. A late no is better than a missed seven-day promise to someone who already paid.

Tools

The stack that is enough

Phone. Vertical. Clean the lens. 4K if it will still export a reasonable file; 1080p is fine for ads. You do not need a cinema camera for a spatula.

CapCut. Captions, cuts, export. Stay off music you cannot license. Silence plus the room plus your voice is legal and human.

A rate card. One page. Pack, rush, extra revision, extra video. Not a Figma palace.

AI for script outlines only. Hook, demo beats, a list of claims to avoid. Then your mouth. Then the throw-away pass.

A simple page. Carrd, Notion, Stan, a Google Doc with two unlisted YouTube or Vimeo embeds. Deposit via Stripe. Email you actually check.

A cheap lav or a quiet room. Optional tripod. Window. That is the studio.

A folder habit. Brand-Product-A-hook1.mp4. Not FinalFinal3.mp4. They own the folder on payment.

The \$0 path

Phone you already own. Window. Two products in the drawer. CapCut free tier. A Notion page. A Stripe or Stan link you already have, or an invoice you send by email with a deposit sentence if you must start uglier. Voice memos on the same phone. Five emails from the address you already use.

You do not need a new domain this week. You do not need a marketplace subscription. You do not need a lighting kit. \$0 is allowed until a brand has paid. Then a \$20 lav if audio was the actual complaint.

What to leave alone

Leave the marketplace apps alone until five organic emails have had a chance. Leave the ring-light shopping cart alone until a brand has paid. Leave the AI-avatar tools alone. This path is your face and a product. Leave the 12-app stack. CapCut and a page.

When to spend

After a paid pack: lav if the kitchen is noisy. Tripod if your arm is the problem. A simple contract template you reuse. Not a camera body. The \$400 pack does not require a new identity.

Checklist

- Niche picked from a drawer you already have
- Two products you own chosen for samples
- Three hooks spoken per product, banner-ad lines thrown out
- Two sample ads shot, 15–30 seconds, product in first two seconds
- Captions on, one short line at a time
- Mute test passed
- Store-aisle test passed: you would say this in a shop
- Rate card: two videos, one revision, seven days, \$400
- Rush +\$150, extra revision +\$75, extra video +\$150 written
- One page with samples, price, deposit link
- Deposit link tested from a second device
- Brief form: facts, claims you will not make, examples they like
- No virality promise anywhere on the page
- Five emails to brands you already buy
- One follow-up four days later
- Deposit before you shoot
- Script said out loud, AI lines you would not say are gone
- Claims from the intake only, no invented statistics
- Vertical files delivered, named, no watermark, folder they own
- One revision window, 48 hours, written notes
- Balance collected
- Ask for the next SKU sent

One referral asked while they are happy

What broke written into a shoot checklist

Stay in the niche for the next pack

Marketplace profile not built instead of emails

No product-only deals accepted

No media buying inside the \$400 pack

FAQ

Do I need followers?

No. Brands paying \$400 for two videos are buying files they can run. Followers are a bonus if you have them. They are not the product. Two samples in the niche beat 40,000 followers in a different niche.

Should I join a UGC marketplace?

You can later. Do not wait on one. Those platforms are useful when you already have a pack and a rate. They are a trap when they are your only channel and the bids start at \$50. Five emails first.

Who pays for the product?

For samples, you do. You already own it. For a paid brief, they ship it or you invoice a product budget. Do not buy \$200 of inventory on a maybe. Deposit first, then shipping.

How long should each video be?

15–30 seconds for v1. Some placements want 6 seconds later. You can cut a 6-second hook from a 20-second file if you shot a clean first line. Do not deliver a 90-second story and call it an ad.

What if I freeze on camera?

Talk to the product, not the lens, for the first sample. Demo-heavy videos hide a shy face. You still need to be willing to be seen. If you cannot, this is the wrong path.

Can I use AI to generate the spokesperson?

Not for this path. Brands hiring UGC want a person. AI is for outlines. You are the mouth.

What about music?

Skip it unless the brand sends a track they own. Trending audio can get an ad pulled. Voice, captions, the sound of the tool — enough.

Do I need an LLC and a contract?

A one-page agreement is enough for pack one: deliverable, timeline, price, revision, claims, who owns the files (they do, on payment). Deposit via Stripe. The agreement cannot wait.

How do I handle a brand that wants 10 videos this week?

That is a different package. Quote it: 10 videos, two revision rounds, 14 days, \$1,600, 50% deposit. Do not say yes at \$400 if you cannot shoot that volume without wrecking another deadline.

What if the first five emails go nowhere?

Send five more in the same niche. Change the subject line to the product you already use. Check that the page loads on a phone. Do not switch to skincare on day eight.

Do I need to be pretty / young / a certain size?

You need to look like a person who would buy the thing. Real kitchens convert. If a brand wants a model, they will say so. Your samples already showed your face. That is a filter. Use it.

Can I batch four brands in one Saturday?

Only if the products are in the same niche and you have deposits from all four. Two brands in a day is a stretch for week one. Four is how files get sloppy and claims slip. Protect the seven-

day promise.

Who owns the files?

They do, on payment. You may keep samples on your page unless they paid extra for exclusive use. Write ownership on the pack page so it is not a fight on day 19.

Should I watermark the samples?

A small end card on the public sample is fine. Do not watermark the paid files. Do not put your logo over their product. They bought the asset, not a demo of you.

What if they hate the hook after I followed the brief?

One revision. Swap the first line if they name the line. If they hate the whole concept, check the form: did they send example ads? If yes and you matched, you are inside the pack. If you ignored their examples, reshoot. That one is on you.

Is \$400 too low / too high?

It is the default once two samples exist. Sit at \$400. Raise after three packs. Do not auction yourself in the first reply.